Virtual Book DEMO

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Get Started

If you like what you see here today, please consider sending me an email to request more information.

Topic Selection

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Consulting Services

Best Practices

Thank You for Your Consideration

Overview

Contents

- About this Virtual Book
- Features & Customization
- Additional Media
- Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

About this Virtual Book

How does your team access the reference materials they need to do their jobs? Do they browse a documents library packed with Word, PDF, or PowerPoint files? Do they pull information directly from articles published on your website? Are they constantly asking their coworkers to send them links to updated resources?

To publish a virtual book, I take your existing documents and display them as an interactive portal that is easy to search, save, and access. Think of the virtual book, not as a single document, but as a small website dedicated to quick reference.

The Virtual Book can work on any modern web browser including Chrome, Firefox, and Edge. As a website, it does not require Adobe, PowerPoint, or Word to run properly, so if your team struggles to use those applications, the virtual book serves as an accessible solution.

As an HTML-5 based site, the virtual book can be hosted on a variety of platforms including SharePoint (as long as custom pages are enabled for the domain by your IT team) as well as GitHub or any other platform that allows you to upload stable HTML pages.

"What does all this mean?"

It means that the creation, publication, and continued maintenance of this book is extremely streamlined and simple. Your instructional content developers can continue publishing their documents, as normal. Meanwhile, your end-users will begin their day by opening their favorite Internet browser, selecting their Virtual Book shortcut, and instantly gain access to a library of resources.

Publication Process

1 Document Preparation

Create and edit your documents as your normally would. Your documents can be prepared as:

- Word (.doc or .docx)
- PDF
- PowerPoint
- PNG or JPG

Not sure if your document can be converted? Please send me an email to inquire.

2 Document Conversion

Your absolute favorite consultant will convert those documents into the Virtual Book format.

- Editing, proofreading, and formatting services are available upon request. See the **Consulting Services** section to learn more.

Conversion is quick and easy.

3 Virtual Book Upload

The finished Virtual Book is then uploaded to your web hosting service of choice.

- Security and permissions can be applied to the Virtual Book to deny public or specific user access.

Examples of hosting services include SharePoint, GitHub, or WordPress, among others.

Sustainability

You have to ask:

"Paul, what if something happens to you? What if you go on vacation or are otherwise unable to update our learning content?"

Upon request, I can train select members of your development team to convert, create, and publish the Virtual Book. In addition, I will work with your IT team or Business Leader to approve and procure the necessary software and licensing involved.

Features & Customization

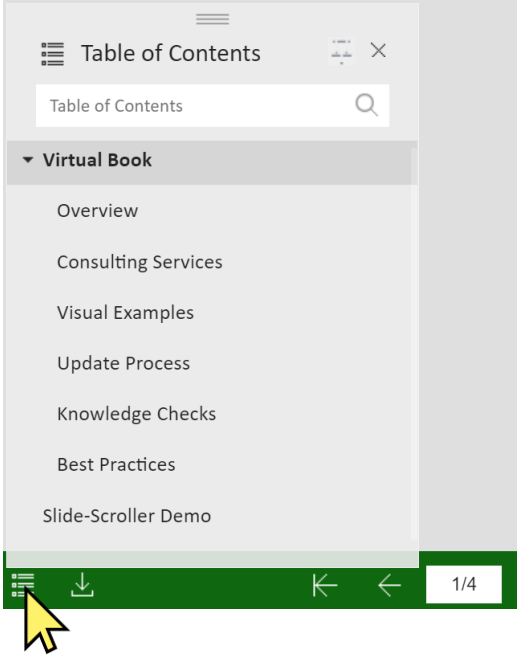
To make the best decision as to whether or not the Virtual Book is right for your team, please review the following features available in this portal:

Dashboard Buttons

Table of Contents

This quick navigation option allows the user to jump between sections of the Virtual Book, open a linked website, or switch between multiple Virtual Book publications.

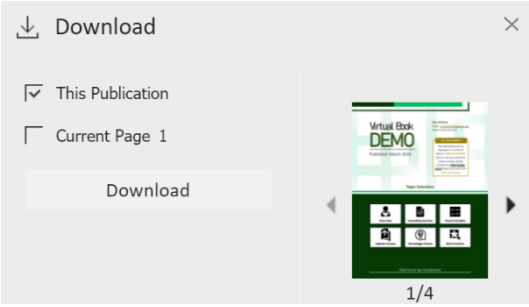
Entries can be entered as categories and subcategories which can be collapsed when needed.



Downloads

The downloads menu offers two options to save offline versions of the Virtual Book. Download options include:

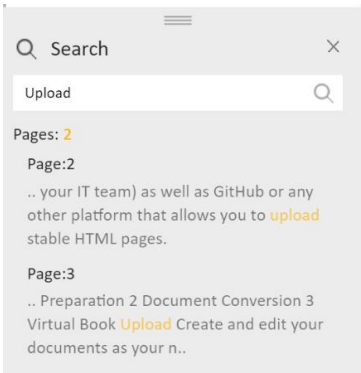
- The entire publication can be saved as a PDF
- Individual pages can be saved as PNG images



In addition, individual files, such as supplementary documents, forms, and other media can be attached to this menu for download

Search

Searching the Virtual Book is quick and simple. The results menu will display the page number a result appears on along with surrounding text:



Page Navigation Buttons

This menu gives users the following navigation options:

- First Page
- Previous Page
- Next Page
- Last Page

Text Selection Toggle

Users can select this button to toggle a text selection tool with a built-in on-screen **copy** feature.

Full Screen

This feature is ideal for small screens or presentations. Use this function display the Virtual Book in full screen mode.

- Press the Esc. Key to exit Full Screen mode.

Zoom In / Out

Double-click your left mouse button to zoom in and out within the Virtual Book. While zoomed in, click and drag your mouse to navigate the screen.

Portal Customization

Does your organization utilize a custom color pallet, font, or require other visual identity? The Virtual Book dashboard and toolbar can be customized according to your needs. A custom logo can be placed in the upper-left corner of the toolbar to maintain your brand identity.

Additional Media

Virtual Books can include:

- Forms & Quizzes
- Audio & Video
- Attestations
- Attached Documents
- Resource Links
- Animations

Quick how-to videos can be embedded into the Virtual Book if your learners benefit from on-screen demonstrations:

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Question	Do you use artificial intelligence (AI) in your instructional design, Virtual Book, or media development?
Answer	No, I believe that AI is a detriment to learning and has distanced trainers from the learning they distribute. In addition, I consider it a “knock off” solution to real facilitation and design. Also, not using AI has saved be countless copyright disputes and intellectual property battles (I’ve got your back, Legal Team).

Question	How long does it take to create a Virtual Book?
Answer	The coding and hosting of a Virtual Book can take less than 8 hours to complete. However, getting source documents edited, sorted, and presentation-worthy takes the most time and depends on the resources of your team and the current state of your library.

Question	Does the Virtual Book conform to ADA compliance?
Answer	Yes! The Virtual book is compatible with screen readers and, upon request, can be equipped with an on-screen narrator for low-vision or blind users.

Question	Is the Virtual Book scalable?
Answer	Yes – multiple documents can be combined into one Virtual Book. In this case, formatting and organization are key to your learners' success.
Question	Can the Virtual Book work offline?
Answer	Yes – offline versions of the Virtual Book can be installed on your devices as .exe files or as Apple or Android applications.
Question	Can Single Sign On (SSO) functionality be implemented?
Answer	This can be prepared at the
Question	How have others used Virtual Books to help their business?
Answer	Truly, the possibilities are endless: • It is ideal for training manuals, reference materials, and employee job aids at all levels of an organization. • Authors may use this format to give prospective readers a digital "preview" of their work. • Restaurants may offer an accessible version of their menus online. It's not about the software, it's about how you use it!
Question	How do I get started?
Answer	Your next project is just an email away. Please contact me at p.nichols0196@gmail.com to request any additional information.

Consulting Services

About Me

Paul Nichols

Adult Education & Employee Training Designer

- 8+ years of experience in employee development
- Master's Degree in Adult Education (2020)
- Certified adult literacy tutor
- Audio, video, and document editor
- Software simulation designer

My Mission

As a legally blind life-long learner, my passion for universal instructional design stems from my own personal investment in education. Very often, I encounter textbooks, presentations, manuals, and reference libraries that serve only a fraction of users at an optimum level while the rest face barriers to entry. My mission is to maintain quality accessibility features throughout the learning process, no matter the platform. This allows employees to focus on their roles and responsibilities instead of the technical challenges they face while retrieving information. At the same time, your editors and document controllers will adhere to clear and simple methods to efficiently version and track updates as they move through the review process. Together, we can achieve universal learning.

My Values

Clarity **Honesty** **Quality** **Adaptability**

My Simple Promise

I shall speak with clarity, act with honesty, create with quality, and plan for adaptability.

Consulting Services Outline

The following list provides a general outline of services that I provide to all clients throughout the consulting period or upon request:

- **Interactive training manual development, publication, and periodic updates including:**
  - Initial setup and coding for HTML-5 web-based content
  - Hosting service identification and troubleshooting
  - Regular updates to the manual's contents and navigation menus
  - Ensure the uniform presentation of company approved logos, brand colors, and signature templates.
  - Integrating supporting links to external tutorials, videos, or forms.
- **Developing attestations and agreements to:**
  - Confirm the review of training manual updates
  - Confirm employee understanding of materials
  - Include integrated videos and tutorials
  - Generate automatic emails upon completion
- **Software simulation development:**
  - Users navigate a specific scenario presented in a training software environment
  - This simulation can incorporate mock call audio and customer information
  - Within the simulation, users can enter text, check-boxes, and retry steps
  - Software Simulations can be uploaded to Cornerstone or other LMS
  - Completion of an exercise can be reported in an LMS system
- **Website and web content development**
- **Email template design and formatting for consistent width and resolution.**
- **General document formatting, editing, and review**
- **Audio and video production and editing including:**
  - Voiceovers
  - Audio tutorials or training audio, such as mock calls
  - How-To Videos
  - Software tutorials
  - Removing protected client information from existing software tutorials or audio.
- **Training workflow and best practice coaching**

Best Practices

Below is a short list of best practices for you and your development team:

Schedule Regular Review Meetings

Schedule regular document review meetings following a standard submission and approval process. This will transform your updates from “reactive” to “pro-active” if meetings follow a focused agenda.

Keep Your Governance Group Small

While constructive ideas are helpful to gather from all areas of your business, it is recommended that document review is kept to a small group. Invite subject experts to meetings as necessary.

Develop Standard Email Templates

Design a standard email template used exclusively when announcing new manual updates to your teams. Emails should include specific page numbers and the section title of the effected segment.

Establish an Update Request Process

Standardize update requests throughout the business. A simple supervisor-level form connected to a central inbox can help filter requests and avoid repeats, if needed.

A Few Random Thoughts

- Don’t shove your entire company newsletter into a regularly-distributed email; nobody will read it, I promise.
- Be extra prudent when introducing authoring or data tracking software to your employees / team. Some individuals will discover these applications for the first time and treat it like a new toy they want everyone to check out.
- A great end-user experience and opportunities for education go hand-in-hand. You cannot have one without the other.

This Concludes the Virtual Book Demo

Thank you